

# The qualification path for Defence Canada work

What KOR must do — in order, with timelines — to be allowed to win DND work. The market is mapped in the defence sector report; this is the how-to-qualify companion. Revalidated 27 August 2026.

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## You can't apply cold — and you don't need to

Since the 2022 reform, a firm cannot self-initiate a federal security clearance: it must be sponsored against a live requirement — and both DCC itself (by email, citing a posted solicitation) and a cleared design-build prime with an active sensitive contract can sponsor a sub-consultant. Critically, **primes may not require an existing clearance to include KOR on a forming team** — teams are named first, clearances follow. So the play is: do the free registrations now, get named on teams, and trigger sponsorship the week it happens. The long pole is organization screening: 2–4 months for the basic level, 6+ months for the full facility clearance.

### ✓ THE SHAPE OF EVERY GATE IN THIS BRIEF

Nothing here stops KOR being *named on a team*. Every requirement — clearance, and now cyber certification — attaches at or after contract award. That is why the cost of preparing is near zero and the cost of being unprepared is the whole pursuit.

## What changed since 3 July

Three things moved in seven weeks. One of them turns a "watch this" item into a task worth doing this week.

### 1. The cyber certification is no longer hypothetical — and it is cheap

The July brief listed CPCSC as an unverified watch item. It is now concrete. **Level 1 has been available to suppliers since 1 April 2026** and begins appearing in select DND contracts from summer 2026 — that is now. Level 1 is a **self-assessment against 13 security controls** drawn from ITSP.10.171, using a free online tool, renewed annually and tracked in CanadaBuys.

The operative detail: **the self-assessment is due at contract award, not during bidding**. It cannot cost KOR a bid it would otherwise have been named on — but an unfinished self-assessment at award is a live problem. Level 2 (98 controls, third-party assessment by an accredited body) phases into select defence contracts from **April 2027 through March 2028** — the July brief's "spring 2027" was close but imprecise.

### → WHAT THIS MEANS FOR KOR

Do the Level 1 self-assessment now, while nothing depends on it. Thirteen controls, free tool, no assessor. It is the cheapest item in this brief and the only one that has a deadline attached to an award KOR has not yet won.

## 2. The Edmonton housing program is far larger than the brief said

The July brief sized CFB Edmonton CFHA Phase 2 at ~\$459M / ~1,010 units. That figure understates the vehicle. Phase 2 of the national housing construction program, launched February 2026, covers **approximately 7,500 new residential housing units across all 25 CFHA locations**, with a DCC advance procurement notice valued at **approximately \$3.74 billion**. Edmonton is among the five largest planned growth sites, with over 1,000 units.

### Solicitations are being initiated in Spring 2026 and Fall 2026, published on MERX.

The fall window is the one KOR is standing in. Phase 1 is already delivering — the first net-zero-emissions-ready apartments at CFB Edmonton were unveiled in July 2026.

## 3. The jetty sponsorship window has closed

IE12347R — the A/B Jetty Recapitalization solicitation named in the July brief as the nearest sponsorship vehicle — **now shows as closed on MERX**. Whether Rory responded before the 14 August deadline is an internal question this brief cannot answer; it is the first thing to confirm, because a submitted response is the clearance-sponsorship trigger and changes what happens next.

For context, the programme itself runs long: A/B Jetty Recapitalization is a ~\$1.1B project completing in 2031, with B Jetty inaugurated February 2025 and A Jetty the live phase. A closed solicitation is not a closed door.

### X ALSO TRUE

Every dated action in the July brief's critical path — the 14 July CFHA prime calls, the 14 August jetty response, the "this week" internal designations — has passed. Section 06 restates them against today's calendar. If the internal ones were never done, they are still free, and still the whole week-zero list.

# Where KOR already stands

| LIVE THREAD                              | STATUS AT 27 AUG 2026                                                                                                                                                               | WHY IT MATTERS HERE                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CFB Esquimalt A/B Jetty Recapitalization | Solicitation IE12347R <b>closed</b> . Team formed as Yellowridge (GC) + DHK Architects + KOR structural + Islander/Gwaii civil (Rory). Whether the response went in is unconfirmed. | Was the nearest sponsorship vehicle. A naval jetty plausibly demands full facility clearance plus Secret personnel — the per-contract SRCL decides, and DCC states it in the advance notice before each RFP. |
| 19 Wing Comox cluster                    | Hangar (\$253M) bid closed; winning prime still not publicly confirmed. Simulator and housing in flight.                                                                            | One DCC Pacific relationship (named contact on file) unlocks four programs. Identify the winning prime before pitching.                                                                                      |
| CFB Edmonton — RPCIP / CFHA Phase 2      | <b>Fall 2026 solicitations now due on MERX.</b> National programme ~7,500 units / ~\$3.74B; Edmonton a top-five site at 1,000+ units.                                               | Bird built Phase 1 — the incumbent prime to court. KOR Edmonton alignment. Being clearance-ready by fall was the point of starting in July.                                                                  |

The defence sector report holds the full pipeline with verdicts and contacts, refreshed live at build; nothing there is repeated here.

## 04 · MECHANICS

# The clearance system, plainly

Two levels for the firm, two for the people.

| LEVEL                                      | WHAT IT ALLOWS                                          | TIMELINE                             | COST                                |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| DOS — Designated Organization Screening    | Protected-level work; personnel screened to Reliability | ~2–4 months                          | Free (fingerprints ~\$40–65/person) |
| FSC — Facility Security Clearance (Secret) | Classified work; personnel to Secret                    | ~6+ months (3–9 end-to-end reported) | Free                                |
| Reliability status (person)                | The baseline for most design work                       | Weeks, once the org is cleared       | —                                   |
| Secret (person)                            | Classified files; typically 2–3 key engineers           | Months                               | —                                   |

#### ✓ WHICH ONE DOES KOR NEED?

There is no discipline-level rule — each contract's Security Requirements Check List decides. Protected-B design work points to DOS; the jetty file plausibly demands FSC plus Secret people. Plan for FSC; celebrate if DOS suffices.

#### SPONSORSHIP MECHANICS

DCC sponsors directly — an email to its industrial-security sponsorship address citing the posted solicitation number — or a CSP-registered prime with an active sensitive contract sponsors its sub. Submit the week a team names KOR, not at award. Inside KOR, two roles must exist first: a **Company Security Officer (CSO) and an alternate (ACSO)** — a designation plus training, not a hire. This can be decided today.

#### 05 • THE OTHER GATES

## Registrations, controlled goods, Indigenous content, cyber

### Cyber certification (CPCSC) — now a task, not a watch item

|               | LEVEL 1                                       | LEVEL 2                                                   |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Available     | 1 April 2026                                  | Phasing April 2027 – March 2028                           |
| In contracts  | Select DND contracts from summer 2026         | Select defence contracts, later                           |
| What it is    | Self-assessment, 13 controls (ITSP.10.171)    | 98 controls, third-party assessment by an accredited body |
| When it's due | <b>At contract award — not at bid</b>         | Requested during procurement                              |
| Upkeep        | Annual self-assessment, tracked in CanadaBuys | Triannual external assessment                             |

Scope follows the data: systems that store, process or transmit sensitive information are in scope, and a supplier cannot push that information into a third-party cloud tenancy and call the tenancy out of scope. A sub-consultant whose systems touch that information is therefore in scope in practice. Whether any given DND contract invokes Level 1 is stated in the contract.

### Registrations

**CanadaBuys / SAP Business Network — already registered.** SAP Business Network ID AN11364928470, account held by Daler Singh (finance). DCC posts everything on MERX; there is no passive DCC supplier registry — entry is competed A&E source-list solicitations or riding a prime's team.

## Controlled Goods Program

Almost certainly **not** needed for structural design of jetties and hangars — the controlled-goods schedule has no infrastructure category. It is a per-contract checkbox; ask DCC when an SRCL appears. If ever triggered: self-initiated (no sponsor needed), ~32+ business days, historically backlogged.

## Indigenous participation

KOR's team is already the answer. The 5% federal target is DCC's obligation, flowing down through prime-held Indigenous Benefits Plans — primes ask subs for Indigenous content, and DCC ran 12.8% Indigenous value last fiscal year. The Islander/Gwaii civil partnership is precisely the card those plans want. Expect these clauses on everything Esquimalt and Comox.

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06 • DO THESE, IN THIS ORDER

## The critical path, re-dated

1

### Confirm what was done in July

Were the CSO and alternate named? Was the AFR screening form pre-filled and signed? Did Rory's response to IE12347R go in before 14 August? All three are free, all three gate everything downstream, and none can be answered from outside KOR.

2

### Do the CPCSC Level 1 self-assessment

Thirteen controls, free tool, no assessor, recorded in CanadaBuys. Due at award on any contract that invokes it — so do it while nothing depends on it.

3

### Keep a signed AFR on the shelf

It must be dated within six months of use, so it is the one document to hold ready for the week a team names KOR.

4

### Get named on an RPCIP Phase 2 team — this fall

Fall 2026 solicitations are due on MERX now. Bird built Edmonton Phase 1; PCL, EllisDon and Pomerleau are the other primes. Team before the posting, not after.

5

### Identify the Comox hangar winner

The \$253M hangar prime is still not publicly confirmed. One DCC Pacific relationship unlocks four programs at 19 Wing.

6

### Sponsorship goes in the week a team names KOR

The AFR rides the bid, or DCC sponsors direct. Then the clock runs: 2–4 months (DOS) to 6+ (FSC). Clearance-in-progress is a legitimate bid answer.

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#### ✓ THE ONE-LINER FOR THE PARTNERS

Everything free still costs nothing. The clearance clock only starts when a team names us — and the fall RPCIP Phase 2 solicitations are the teams to be named on. Get on the teams.

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07 • HONEST LABELS

# What's solid, what's carried forward, what nobody outside KOR can answer

- **Verified this pass** **CPCSC Level 1** — availability date, 13 controls, self-assessment at award, annual renewal; Level 2 scope and the April 2027 – March 2028 phase-in. PSPC announcement material plus independent corroboration, 27 Aug 2026.
- **Verified this pass** **RPCIP / CFHA Phase 2** — ~7,500 units, ~\$3.74B advance notice, Edmonton 1,000+ units, Spring and Fall 2026 solicitations on MERX. DND and DCC announcements, 27 Aug 2026.
- **Verified this pass** **IE12347R closed**; A/B Jetty ~\$1.1B completing 2031, B Jetty inaugurated Feb 2025. MERX listing and public reporting.
- **Carried forward** **The clearance rules themselves** — no-cold-application, sponsorship routes, the AFR six-month rule, DOS/FSC timelines, CGP non-applicability, Indigenous flow-down. Primary-verified against canada.ca on 3 July 2026 and **not re-fetchable today**: canada.ca returns 403 to automated requests. No contrary evidence surfaced in this pass, but re-confirmation needs one logged-in browser session.
- **Internal – unknown** **Whether July's free actions were done** — CSO and ACSO named, AFR pre-filled, and whether Rory answered IE12347R before it closed. Ask; do not assume.
- **Not public** **19 Wing Comox hangar winning prime** — unchanged since July.
- **Per-contract** **Each solicitation's exact clearance level** — the notice states it; not researchable in advance.

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KOR Structural — Confidential / Internal · Prepared 2026-07-03, updated 2026-07-10, **revalidated 2026-08-27** · Companion to the live defence sector report (pipeline and contacts).

Sources: PSPC Contract Security Program and CPCSC pages · dcc-cdc.gc.ca · MERX · CanadaBuys · DND announcements · industry reporting. Filed in the BD database.